

# Tran Zha

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**Engineering Manager | Platform Modernisation | Technical Leadership | Brisbane, Australia |**  
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## Professional Summary

Engineering Manager with 15+ years of experience building software products, leading teams and modernising complex platforms. I help teams make sense of messy legacy systems, turn unclear problems into practical delivery plans, and keep business-critical work moving without losing sight of quality. My leadership style mirrors effective LLM engineering: clear intent, enough context, practical guardrails, measurable success and tight feedback loops. I use LLM tools in work and personal projects to speed up research, prototyping, documentation and analysis, while keeping human review and engineering judgement at the centre.

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## Leadership & AI-Aware Delivery Strengths

- **Prompt engineering / clear communication:** Turns blurry requests into explicit intent, trade-offs, decisions and next steps so teams and stakeholders know what is actually being asked.
- **Context engineering / shared why:** Gives teams the background, constraints and business reasoning behind work, so implementation choices fit the problem instead of only the ticket.
- **Spec and harness engineering / delivery guardrails:** Defines goals, boundaries, operating agreements and measurable success criteria, making "good" concrete and reducing tangents.
- **Loop engineering / autonomous improvement:** Sets clear goals, then drives build-test-verify-deploy-feedback loops so teams can make local decisions without micromanagement.
- **People leadership and coaching:** Team coaching, expectation-setting, hiring support, career development, performance conversations and no-surprise feedback loops.
- **Platform and architecture judgement:** Strangler Fig migration, monolith decomposition, backward compatibility, REST, CQRS, event-driven design, clean architecture, VSA, domain modelling and service boundaries.
- **Product, stakeholder and domain alignment:** Discovery, roadmap and scope/debt trade-offs, BAU/CI, executive communication, vendors, third parties, cross-team dependencies, CRM/contact/ownership/authorisation/reporting/migration domains and PII data handling.

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## Professional Experience

### **LMG / Loan Market Group - Engineering Manager, MyCRM Replatforming**

**Feb 2023 - Present**

#### **Contact Replatform - centralising contact mutation and retrieval | Jun 2025 - Present**

- Leading the highest-complexity MyCRM replatform initiative: contacts are entangled across more than half of the monolith's business logic, with historical edge cases and patches spread across screens, workflows and services.
- Building Contact v2 with backward compatibility and future-facing architecture, while untangling fragmented product logic into centralised mutation/retrieval paths and clearer ownership/auth boundaries.
- Using a Strangler Fig approach: facade over the existing data store first, gradual migration of legacy consumers, then replacement of the underlying data model once behaviours are controlled.
- Positioning Contact as a reference architecture for future MyCRM work, applying CQRS, domain and integration events, gRPC internal communication, clean architecture, Vertical Slice Architecture and stronger service boundaries.
- Partnering with product, architecture and frontend teams to introduce a new Material UI-based design system while preserving legacy interoperability during migration.

#### **Diversified Deals Replatform - generic engagement model for financial deals | Feb 2023 - Jun 2025**

- Led replatforming of residential-focused deal capability into a generic Engagement model that can handle multiple product types to support business growth.
- Used the Engagement platform to launch asset finance, commercial and insurance deal journeys, expanding MyCRM beyond residential lending without duplicating core deal logic.
- Drove domain modelling, transition planning, roadmap alignment and stakeholder trade-offs across product, engineering and business groups.
- Reset expectations and delivery discipline in a struggling team, improving clarity, technical direction and execution focus across a long-running replatform program.

### **LMG / Loan Market Group - Engineering Manager, Commission System / Business Insights / Podium Data Migration**

**Mar 2021 - Apr 2023**

- Built and led teams across commissions, reporting/analytics and acquisition migration programs; shaped business cases, roadmaps, discovery and delivery plans for complex domains.

- Evaluated Snowflake, Starburst, ThoughtSpot, BigQuery, Sisense and related platforms; separated data lake/warehouse concerns and delivered ingestion, transformation and reporting pipelines.
- Led migration work after acquisitions, including one-off and overnight delta pipelines using SSIS, TaskFactory, Salesforce, Kubernetes jobs and AWS services; supported onshore growth from ~10 to 30+ engineers.

## **LMG / Loan Market Group - Engineering Manager, MyCRM Platform Modernisation**

**Jul 2019 - Apr 2021**

- Introduced OpenTelemetry, contextual logging, GitHub Actions and Octopus, improved local development workflows, and led containerisation and Kubernetes/EKS migrations.

## **NZFSG - Senior DevOps Engineer / Senior Engineer, MyCRM Launch and Cloud Modernisation**

**Apr 2016 - Jun 2019**

- Helped rebuild, launch and modernise MyCRM across Australia/New Zealand; migrated from on-premise to AWS, CI/CD and improved observability; coordinated security audit activity.
- Supported offshore expansion from 0 to 30+ engineers and QA staff; team mentoring and culture building; Scrum master for multiple teams.
- Managed cloud spend, software licensing and vendor cost inputs for the MyCRM platform, balancing operational needs with budget and delivery priorities.
- Supported production operations, incident response and service reliability for business-critical CRM systems, using monitoring and support feedback to drive continuous improvement.

## **LifeDirect / Inform Holdings / Trade Me - Software Engineer**

**Jul 2008 - Mar 2016**

- Full-stack engineering across online insurance, internal admin, reporting, CRM and hosting operations; built quoting, application and underwriting workflows and mentored team members as the function grew.

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## **Technical Toolkit**

AWS, GCP, EKS/Kubernetes, Docker, GitHub Actions, Octopus, OpenTelemetry, Elasticsearch, Snowflake, BigQuery, ThoughtSpot, Firebase, Supabase, Serverless, C#/.NET, SQL Server, PostgreSQL, DDD, REST, CQRS, HTTP/gRPC, event-driven architecture, data lake/warehouse, ETL and data migration pipelines

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## AI/LLM-Assisted Personal Projects

- **mqcyb.tranzha.com - Math Quiz / mqcyb:** Flutter learning app previously released on the App Store; used AI assistance for rapid feature iteration, UI refinement and content generation support.
- **transtags.tranzha.com - Bank transaction categorisation and tax returns:** React/Node.js product experiment for importing bank transactions, categorising spending and preparing tax-return exports; explored Supabase before pausing the project.
- **sports.tranzha.com - Community sports registration and mini CRM:** Next.js/Node.js/Firebase app for registrations, participants and lightweight community operations management.
- **Roblox Autorun Obby:** Roblox game/prototype using AI-assisted scripting, level iteration and gameplay experimentation.

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## Education, Coursework & Languages

Postgraduate Diploma in Science, Computer Science - University of Auckland | Bachelor of Science, Computer Science - University of Auckland | Bachelor of Commerce, Finance and Economics - University of Auckland

AWS Solutions Architect Associate coursework completed (A Cloud Guru); Kubernetes Administrator coursework completed (Udemy); Machine Learning and Deep Learning coursework completed (Coursera/deeplearning.ai); Certified Scrum Master | English, Mandarin | References available on request